

# Lesson 9: Phonogram a

Stage 1 · Lesson 9 · phonogram-intro

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## Warm-Up: Phonogram Flash Review

Adult: Flash previously taught phonogram cards. Child says ALL sounds within 2 seconds.

### Phonograms to review

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(This is your first phonogram lesson! Skip review today.)

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## New Learning: Your New Phonogram — a

### The Phonogram a



**a** says 3 sounds: /ă/ /ā/ /ä/

| Sound | Example Words |
|-------|---------------|
| /ă/   | at, cat, hat  |
| /ā/   | nation, acorn |
| /ä/   | father, spa   |

**Important:** Always teach ALL sounds from the start. Never teach "a says /ă/" and add more later. The child must know that **a** can say 3 different things.

### How to Write a

1. Start at the midline.
2. Curve around to make a circle (counter-clockwise).
3. Go up and down in a straight line.

Write **a** three times on your whiteboard or in a sand tray. Say "/ă/ /ā/ /ä/" each time you write it.

### Vowel or Consonant?

**a** is a **vowel**. You can sing it! Your mouth is open. Your lips, tongue, and teeth don't block the sound.

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## Spelling Analysis

Follow the 5-step routine for each word:

1. **Hear & Say** — Adult says the word, uses it in a sentence. Child repeats.
2. **Segment** — Child breaks the word into individual sounds. Adult holds up fingers (1 finger = 1-letter phonogram).

3. **Write** — Child writes the word while sounding it out.
4. **Analyze** — Underline multi-letter phonograms. Name any spelling rules.
5. **Read** — Child reads the word sound by sound, then blends.

| Word | Phonograms Used  | Rules Applied                 | Say-to-Spell |
|------|------------------|-------------------------------|--------------|
| at   | a (/ă/), t (/t/) | Short vowel — closed syllable | /ăt/         |
| am   | a (/ă/), m (/m/) | Short vowel — closed syllable | /ăm/         |
| an   | a (/ă/), n (/n/) | Short vowel — closed syllable | /ăn/         |

## Reading Practice

Read these words sound by sound, then blend:

at am an ad ag

## Handwriting Practice

Write each letter once. Say its sounds as you write.

|          |          |          |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| <b>a</b> | <b>a</b> | <b>a</b> | <b>a</b> | <b>a</b> |
|          |          |          |          |          |
|          |          |          |          |          |

## Quick Check

1. What did you learn today? (*A new phonogram: a*)
2. What sounds does **a** say? (/ă/ /ā/ /ä/)
3. Write the word "at" from dictation.

**Next lesson:** Lesson 10: Phonogram d

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*Practice at home: Flash your new a card 5 times. Find a in a book or on a sign.*